

Live Campaign Performance Analysis

Meta Ads — “Spiti Reel” Engagement Campaign

A self-funded, live paid-media campaign run through Meta Ads Manager, with creative shot and edited by the author.

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Executive Summary

This report is a critical analysis of a live engagement campaign run on Meta Ads Manager to drive Instagram profile visits. Unlike an academic proposal, every figure here is drawn from a real campaign that spent a real budget of **₹1,270.30**. The campaign returned **3,506 profile visits at ₹0.36 per result**, which Meta’s own peer comparison placed **19% below the median cost of comparable ad sets** running in the same window.

The headline efficiency is strong, but the more valuable findings sit in the breakdowns. The campaign reached a predominantly male audience (72% of reach), yet women converted materially cheaper (₹0.33 against ₹0.39). Meanwhile 63% of budget was allocated to the less efficient male segment. The single video creative also showed an early-stage retention drop-off. Each of these is a concrete, evidence-based lever for a cheaper next campaign, and each is discussed below.

1. Campaign Overview

The objective was engagement, optimised specifically for Instagram profile visits. In terms of the Hierarchy of Effects model (Smith et al., 2008) applied in the author’s earlier campaign work, a profile-visit objective sits at the *behavioural* stage of the funnel: the goal is not passive awareness but an active step, a user choosing to tap through and view the profile. Success is therefore measured by cost per action, not by impressions alone.

The campaign ran from 31 July to 6 August 2026 on a ₹230 daily budget, built in Ads Manager rather than boosted. The audience used Advantage+, but with deliberate interest targeting layered on top — travel photography, backpacking, hiking and camping, adventure travel, and landscape photography — and an age lean toward 20 to 40. This is a considered setup, not broad-and-hope: the analyst gave the algorithm a relevant starting signal, then *read where it delivered efficiently and where budget was wasted*. The creative was a single travel Reel, shot and edited by the author, run across Instagram feed, Stories, Reels, Explore and profile placements.

2. Performance Summary

The table below maps each headline metric to the funnel stage it represents, so performance is read as a journey from awareness to action rather than as a list of disconnected numbers.

Metric	Result	Read
Amount spent	₹1,270.30	Self-funded test budget
Reach	63,186 accounts	Cognitive stage — awareness
Impressions	77,827	Delivered almost entirely on Instagram
Instagram profile visits	3,506	Behavioural stage — action taken
Action rate (visits ÷ impressions)	~4.5%	Strong for an engagement objective
Cost per result	₹0.36	19% below comparable ad sets
New Instagram follows	13	Bonus downstream result

Read as a funnel, 77,827 impressions produced 3,506 profile visits, an action rate of roughly 4.5%. For an engagement objective this is healthy: a comfortable share of the people who saw the ad took the intended behavioural step, and at a cost that beat the peer benchmark.

3. Critical Analysis

3.1 Efficiency against a real benchmark

The strongest single result is external, not self-reported. Meta’s platform benchmark placed the cost per profile visit **19% below the median of comparable ad sets** running in the same period. This matters because it removes the analyst’s bias from the claim: the efficiency is measured against real peers, not against a target the author set for himself. On a modest ₹1,270 budget, the spend worked harder than the market median for the same objective.

3.2 The audience efficiency paradox

The most instructive finding is a mismatch between where the ad was delivered and where it performed. The breakdown is set out below.

Segment	Share of reach	Results	Cost per result
Men	72% (45,282)	2,062	₹0.39
Women	28% (17,904)	1,391	₹0.33

The algorithm delivered 72% of reach to men, yet women converted roughly 15% cheaper, at ₹0.33 against ₹0.39. In other words, the segment that received the *least* exposure was the *most* efficient. Even with relevant interests set, an Advantage+ layer can steer early delivery before the cheaper segment is fully discovered. The practical implication is direct: a campaign that nudges delivery toward the female audience, or tests a female-leaning creative, would likely lower the blended cost per result without any increase in spend.

3.3 Budget allocation

The allocation compounds the paradox above. 63% of the budget (₹801.50) was spent reaching men, the less efficient segment, while only 37% (₹465.67) went to the cheaper-converting women. This is not a

failure of the campaign so much as a limitation of letting delivery run untouched: the money followed the algorithm's initial read rather than the efficiency data that only became visible after the fact. It is exactly the kind of post-campaign insight that should feed the next campaign's structure.

3.4 Creative and the affective drop-off

Between the cognitive stage (being reached) and the behavioural stage (visiting the profile) sits the affective stage: holding interest. Meta's own diagnostic flagged a retention gap here, with a high volume of three-second video plays but a much smaller number reaching the ThruPlay milestone. Read against the funnel, this is affective-stage leakage: the opening frame earned attention and the call to action converted well, but the middle of the video lost a share of viewers before they finished. Exact ThruPlay figures should be confirmed from the delivery report, but the direction is clear and actionable.

4. Limitations

A credible analysis states its own boundaries. This campaign's conclusions are constrained by:

- **Scale.** A ₹1,270 self-funded budget is a test, not a brand budget. The efficiency is real but demonstrated at small volume.
- **Hybrid targeting.** Interest targeting was layered on an Advantage+ audience, so Meta still influenced final delivery on top of the signals set. Audience findings therefore partly describe algorithmic behaviour, not a fully controlled manual experiment.
- **Single creative.** With one Reel and no A/B variant, creative conclusions are directional. There is no counterfactual to isolate what a different hook would have done.
- **Objective ceiling.** Profile visits are an upper-funnel behavioural signal, not a sale. Efficiency here does not by itself prove downstream conversion value.

5. Recommendations for the Next Campaign

- **Reweight toward the efficient segment.** Test a delivery split or a creative angle that leans into the female audience, which converted 15% cheaper, and measure whether blended cost per result falls.
- **Fix the affective drop-off.** Run two or three alternative video openings against the same audience to find the hook that carries viewers past the three-second mark and into a completed view.
- **Introduce a second creative format.** Add a static or carousel variant so the system can serve the most effective format per user, reducing reliance on a single Reel and guarding against creative fatigue.
- **Add conversion tracking.** Instrument the profile and any linked page so the next campaign can measure past the profile visit, connecting engagement to a downstream action.

6. Conclusion

On its own terms the campaign succeeded: it delivered 3,506 profile visits at ₹0.36 each, 19% below the market benchmark, using creative the author produced end to end. But the value of the exercise is not the headline number. It is the ability to interrogate a live result, find the audience efficiency paradox, question the budget allocation, and locate the creative drop-off, then translate each into a specific,

testable change. That is the difference between running an ad and managing performance. Certifications demonstrate knowledge of the platform; this campaign demonstrates judgement on it.